10 per cent each who prefer a large private company or a start-up or small business.

This is a paradox because this is India's most digitally connected and entrepreneurial generation, coming of age amid Start-up India, Digital India and a raft of new-economy opportunities. Yet, almost half of them still hanker after the security of a government job. Moreover, 63 per cent place the primary responsibility for providing jobs on the Union and state governments. Governments, no doubt, have a responsibility to improve the quality of education and expand opportunities. But Gen Z should also realise that it is dangerous to expect the state to be the principal provider of secure employment and not look at entrepreneurship, private

The survey found that Gen Z is filled with doubt that hard work will not be enough to get ahead in the country

They are coming of age amid a raft of new-economy opportunities. Yet almost half of them still hanker after the security of a government job

enterprise, new skills and emerging sectors as routes to shaping one's own future.

Policymakers should take note that the sense of insecurity extends to whether their future lies in India at all. Only 37 per cent believe the country is moving in the right direction against 46 per cent who think otherwise. As many as 38 per cent would prefer to work abroad if a good opportunity arose; another 34 per cent would go abroad temporarily before returning. Better salaries and career prospects are by far the biggest attraction, cited by 36 per cent, followed by better education at 16 per cent and more merit-based opportunities at 13 per cent.

It is on education and exams that anxiety

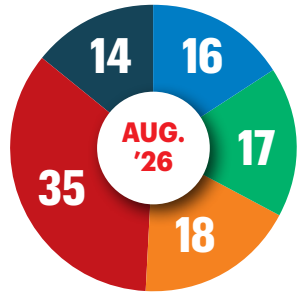


Q. What should be the top priority for reforming India's education system?

Improve teaching quality	27
Make education more employment-oriented	24
Reform entrance and recruitment exams	15
Expand vocational and skills education	14
Encourage research, creativity and critical thinking	12

Rest DK/CS

Q. How would you rate the Union government's handling of the 2026 NEET paper-leak crisis?



The fact that the Centre dilly-dallied till the crisis blew up has not gone down well

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say